Every part of her body quavered under his touch. She would remember this moment and all the other moments. He was the man she loved more than any other, which is why she had to let him go.

"It's good to see you," he said. "Assembling time fuses for bombs makes me dead inside. Then I come here and you bring me back to life." He leaned close and kissed her. She let herself kiss him back because she knew that after today, she would never kiss him again. *I love you. I'm sorry for what I'm about to do.* She pulled away, stepped back, and turned toward the river.

"Is everything all right?" he asked.

"It's been a busy day." Her voice was taut. She wished André knew her better than Reinhardt, could see through her and probe, make her confess her deal with Reinhardt, then talk her out of it, say she couldn't stay, that he had a plan and she would marry him. Then everything would be fine. That was the dream. Reality was the paper she'd signed. She belonged to Reinhardt. The ring in her pocket reminded her. She had to forge on.

"I'm still grieving Nadiya," Rose said. "Poor Katya to have lost her mother like that."

He stroked her arm slowly and softly. "You and Léa are filling in so well for Nadiya. You'll both make sure Katya leads a good life."

He stepped behind her, wrapping his arms around her waist, and held her. She loved his chest, solid and sure against her back, ready to catch her if she fell. She took a deep breath, steeled herself, and pushed his hands away.

"Whoa, what's happening? I can feel the tension in your shoulders. Did the Meister yell at you today?"

"No. Sorry, I feel different . . ."

"Rose, what's wrong?"

"I told you, I feel different."

He turned her around to face him. "About?"

She looked down. He put his hand under her chin, lifting it to look at her. "About us."

He winced as if he'd been stung by a bee. Hands akimbo, his mouth gaped open. "Come on," he said. "Stop joking around."

"I'm not joking."

Silence. His mouth pinched.